THE DABBLER'S RISK

Your AI SaaS doesn't have a churn problem.

It has a tourist problem.

Tourist vs Resident

Tourist: tries 100 AI tools a year, signs up, pokes around, leaves.

Resident: picks 3, builds their workflow around them.

You’re optimizing for the wrong one

Most founders design their funnel to attract tourists — without realizing it.

Signals you’re attracting tourists

- Signups trending up
- 30-day retention below 20%
- ‘Time to value’ metrics look great
- Revenue doesn’t compound

Activation high. Residency zero.

The two numbers look different on a dashboard. They're the same failure.

Residents don’t stay for features

They stay for:

- Workflows they can’t rebuild elsewhere
- Data they’ve invested in
- Habits you’ve helped form
- Networks they’ve connected to

Feature defensibility dies. Behavior defensibility compounds.

One is a snapshot. The other is a moat.

Stop measuring activation. Start measuring residency.

% of signups still logging in at week 12+.

That number is your actual business.

At $100K ARR, residency is under 8%

That's the Dabbler's Risk.

The math breaks inside 18 months.

Positioning selects for residents before signup.

Onboarding can’t fix what the funnel let in.

Follow @muddassir for retention systems for AI founders.